

last week by Harvard's new president, historian Drew Gilpin Faust.

It's an initiative that caps the university's inexorable mission to win India, towards which it has committed \$1 million (Rs 3.9 crore) in the initial stage. It also recognises, says Mahindra, India's importance on the world stage. In January, the Kennedy School of Government launched an executive education programme for senior members of the Indian Administrative

Service (IAS), developed in collaboration with the Indian Institute of Management, Ahmedabad, which expects to train 360 senior IAS officers over a three-year period. This summer, Harvard and the Tata Group funded 57 undergraduate and graduate students in the US to go to India to study or participate in internships, a huge increase from three students three years ago. The Harvard School of Public Health has collaborated with the Government of India and

corporations. The importance the institute attaches to the initiative is reflected in the eight stalwarts it has placed in the steering committee for SAI, including Amartya Sen, Lamont University professor; Homi K. Bhabha, Anne E. Rothenberg professor of humanities; Sugata Bose, director of the South Asia Initiative and Gardiner professor of oceanic history and affairs; Tarun Khanna, Jorge Paulo Lemann professor at IBS; Krishna G. Palepu, Ross Graham Walker professor of business administration at IBS; and Rohini Pande, Mohamed Kamal professor of public policy at the Kennedy School of Government. It is also reflected in the 193 students from India who were enrolled at Harvard in 2006-07, the fourth largest contingent outside the US, and twice the number who graduated 10 years ago.

Mahindra kicked off the planning process in January with a two-hour brainstorming session of movers and shakers, convened by Harvard and hosted by him, at the annual meeting of the World Economic Forum—he was also the first to commit \$1 million in funding. This was the first of a number of individual and group meetings held throughout the world, primarily by Vice Provost for International Affairs Jorge I. Domínguez and Associate Director for University Advancement Eric Sinoway, who in March, undertook a "listening tour" to India. The faculty and alumni have also had a series of meetings with the Government, which individually and informally seems gung-ho about Harvard—the grumbling by the Left about foreign universities notwithstanding—but has refrained from holding forth on the engagement in public. Harvard has hosted Indian ministers, most recently External Affairs Minister Pranab Mukherjee last year to speak on India's security perspective and Finance Minister P. Chidambaram last month to speak on "poor rich countries: the challenges of development". It even got Prime Minister Manmohan Singh to speak at its two-day Alumni Association global series in Delhi last year.

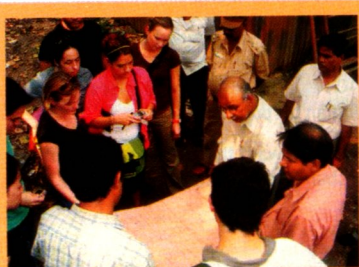
India has been in focus at Harvard for long. Sanskrit was first taught at the institute in 1872 by James Bradford Greenough. In the 1880s, the university established the department of Indo-Iranian Languages. In 1911, Harvard

INDIA

In a \$12 million plan spurred by its stalwart faculty and aided by star alumni, Harvard is reaching out to Indians as extensively as it is educating Americans about one of the world's most significant economies



DREAM TEAM: The South Asia Initiative committee (sitting, from left): Tarun Khanna, Rohini Pande and Homi K. Bhabha; (standing from left): Amartya Sen, Jennifer Leaning, Sugata Bose, Krishna G. Palepu and Leonard van der Kuip



ON THE JOB: Harvard professor Niall Kirkwood and Maximum Mumbai, Minimum Mumbai team; (below) a Harvard student in India



the Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation to form the Public Health Foundation of India (PHFI) while the IBS-funded India Research Centre (IRC) in Mumbai has contributed to over 40 research projects and cases about Indian companies.

It is an extraordinary confluence of alumni initiative and university interest, the result of 11 months of intensive consultations across Harvard with leaders around the world, and similar to the university's Japan and China programmes, funded by their large